

WSJ DAILY BRIEFING

A-Grade Edition

Saturday, June 13, 2026

Market Tone: Broadly Positive (+0.3-0.8% major indices)

SPX: 7,431 (+0.5%) | DJIA: 51,202 (+0.7%) | NDX: 25,889 (+0.3%)

Curated by Hermes Agent - Nous Research

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Wall Street closed a turbulent week on a high note as SpaceX's record-shattering IPO and a sharp drop in oil prices on Iran deal hopes powered a broad market advance. The S&P 500 rose 0.5% to 7,431, the Dow added 0.7% to 51,202, and the Nasdaq gained 0.3% to 25,889. The Russell 2000 surged 3.9% for the week — the best performer YTD at +18.6% — as investors rotated into small caps and momentum plays.

TOP STORY: SPACEX HISTORIC IPO

SpaceX, Now Worth \$2.1 Trillion, Pulls Off Goldilocks Debut

SpaceX marked the largest IPO in history on Friday, rallying 19.2% in its first day of trading on the Nasdaq. The rocket company opened at \$150 per share after pricing at \$135, closing at \$160.95 — making Elon Musk the world's first trillionaire.

By the Numbers:

- \$75 billion raised — largest IPO ever, 4x oversubscribed
- Day 1 close: \$160.95 (+19.2%) — market cap ~\$2.1 trillion
- Elon Musk surpassed \$1 trillion net worth
- Over \$70 billion in retail orders
- Set to join Nasdaq-100 in 15 trading days

Analyst Commentary:

- CFRA: Issued sell rating post-IPO, warning valuation may be stretched
- Wolfe Research: "Out-of-this-world" valuation supported by rocket launch moat
- Jay Woods (Freedom Capital): "Watch how we trade Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday"
- Walter Isaacson: "Beginning of a whole new economy"

Signal: The Magnificent Seven traded sideways as investors likely sold Big Tech to free up capital for SpaceX. OpenAI and Anthropic are expected to go public later this year — this IPO serves as a bellwether.

MARKETS

Market Data — Friday Close

S&P 500: 7,431.46 (+0.5%) | Dow: 51,202.26 (+0.7%) | Nasdaq: 25,888.84 (+0.3%) | Russell 2000: 2,943.99 (+0.8%)
 Brent Crude: ~\$87 (-3.4%) | Gold: ~\$4,237 (+2.5%) | US 10Y: 4.48%

Key Market Themes

- Small caps outperform: Russell 2000 hit all-time highs, best YTD at +18.6%
- Big Tech lags: Mag 7 traded sideways for second straight week
- Chips rebound: SOXX up 11% for the week after tumbling 6% prior week
- Equal weight wins: Invesco S&P 500 Equal Weight ETF (RSP) outperforming
- Oil plunge: Brent below \$90 on Iran deal hopes

ECONOMY & POLICY

Inflation Hits 4% — First Time in Three Years

This week's consumer prices data showed annual inflation climbing above 4% for the first time in three years, adding to conviction that the Fed will be unable to cut rates anytime soon.

Fed Meeting Preview: Kevin Warsh's First as Chair

The Federal Reserve meets June 16-17 — the first helmed by Kevin Warsh. Expected to hold rates steady. Key watchpoints: any removal of easing language, Summary of Economic Projections, and communication style changes. Odds of a rate cut this year: virtually zero (CME FedWatch).

GEOPOLITICS

U.S. and Iran: From Renewed War to the Cusp of Peace

In a dramatic 24-hour reversal, President Trump cancelled planned strikes against Iran on Thursday amid renewed peace discussions. The U.S. sees an 80-85% chance of an Iran deal being signed. Brent crude dropped 3.4% on the news.

Also in Geopolitics:

Israel has planned a series of military strikes against Iran over the next two weeks (WSJ)

Trump says U.S. killed Venezuelan Tren de Aragua gang leader

Kennedy Center misses deadline to remove Trump's name

TECHNOLOGY & AI

Anthropic Halts Top AI Models After U.S. Ban on Foreign Use

Anthropic, valued at ~\$965 billion, suspended access to top-tier AI models following a U.S. government ban on foreign use of advanced AI systems.

The AI Price War Is Here

Startups and tech giants are mixing and matching AI models to avoid premium prices charged by OpenAI and Anthropic. Competition intensifies across the ecosystem.

Other Tech Headlines:

AI Needs Ajinomoto's Film — chip material supply chain pressure points

Rocket Lab and 4 other space stocks joining the Nasdaq 100

Pope Leo compares AI threat to Biblical "Tower of Babel"

BUSINESS HIGHLIGHTS

Sleep Number files for Chapter 11 bankruptcy, acquired by Sleep Country Canada for \$415M

McDonald's and Coke: strained 70-year partnership challenged by changing tastes

Paramount-WBD \$81B deal cleared by DOJ, pending European approval

BlackRock private-credit fund faces 13% redemption requests (capped at 5%)

Flutter Entertainment (FanDuel) to delist from London, trade solely in New York

Blockworks acquires Messari at a steep discount (~\$10M vs ~\$300M valuation in 2022)

JBS closing Pennsylvania beef plant amid U.S. cattle shortage

Bond investor Ken Leech pleads guilty to obstructing SEC probe

Jeep park-outside fire recall now includes 1 million vehicles

WEEK AHEAD: JUNE 15-19

Mon: Empire State Index, Industrial Production, NAHB Housing Index

Tue: Housing Starts, Import/Export Prices — FOMC meeting begins

Wed: Retail Sales — FOMC Decision + SEP at 2:00 PM ET

Thu: Jobless Claims, Philly Fed Index — Earnings: Accenture, Kroger

Fri: Markets closed for Juneteenth

SIGNAL WATCH

SpaceX aftermarket performance — IPO volatility test continues

Fed's first Warsh meeting — hawkish shift risk

Iran deal trajectory — oil pricing in a deal, breakdown risk

Inflation above 4% — rate-cut hopes crushed

Small cap momentum — Russell 2000 at all-time highs